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Chapter 5

Style Advanced Shipping Notices

Overview



Introduction

Style Advanced Shipping provides the following functions, which are described more fully later:

- Master File Maintenance.
- Build and Maintain Shipping Consignments.
- Stock Reservation.
- ASNs and ANSI X12 856 ASNs.

Style Advanced Shipping Notices is an advanced business module and this overview assumes that you are familiar with the following:

- A knowledge of how the Server operates.
- A knowledge of how the JBA modules work.
- An understanding of Customer Scheduling in a repetitive manufacturing environment.
- Knowledge of how goods are collated and despatched.

Master File Maintenance

The Style Advanced Shipping Notices module aims to cater for the special requirements of repetitive supply chain industries, for example in the apparel or footwear sectors.

The module allows you to manage and monitor complex supply contracts. Style Advanced Shipping Notices provides maintenance functions which are explained in more detail later in this section:

- Company
- Customer
- Contract

These are repetitive functions which filter the default values down from company to customer, and from customer to contract level. This minimises the amount of keying involved in setting up a new contract whilst allowing the flexibility of overrides at the lower levels.

Advanced Customer Scheduling calls Advanced Shipping Maintenance Default screens when you enter new contracts and customers. These defaults are also maintained within Advanced Shipping Notices. Other key Advanced Shipping Notice master files are:

- Name and Address. These define the EDI 'Trading Partner' details for sending Advanced Shipping Notices (ASN's) to be sent by EDI.
- Pack and Pallet Information. These define the parameters of a particular pack type; a particular pallet type and the relationship of a customer / item with a specific pack and pallet.

Build and Maintain Consignments

This function allows you to create or maintain consignments on which to ship to a specified customer on a specified day. It is the main area of the Advanced Shipping Notices processing function.

- Default action quantities are suggested; sourcing is suggested against the available stock in priority sequence until either the requirement is satisfied or no stock remains. Suggested stock allocations are in pack rounded quantities where appropriate. Action quantities can be forced through which will make available stock negative. This is assuming the stockroom has been set up in Style Inventory Management to accept negative stock.

Consignment Invoices

Shipments may be invoiced either according to normal consolidation rules (daily, weekly, monthly).

Consignment Notes

Confirm Consignment will produce a Consignment Note which summarises despatches for the consignment regardless of the stockroom. (Pick notes, if required, will be produced for each stockroom).

The Consignment Note will give brief pack and pallet details where appropriate.

Pack and Pallet Details

- A 'Pallet' is an outer container; it may be a large crate which packs sit in, or a traditional pallet which packs sit on top of.
- A 'Pack' is the inner container an item is shipped in and the normal 'pack' quantity is used in Pack Rounding.

The system uses some basic rules to produce pack and pallet details for the goods on a consignment. The system creates details for each combination of:

- Item
- Consignment
- Contract
- Stockroom

The system assumes different lot numbers can be mixed on a pallet, but not in a pack, and that different product's cannot be mixed on a pallet, or in a pack. You can later manipulate the pack and pallet details.

Specifications can be made for pack quantities, number of packs per pallet layer, a minimum number of layers and a maximum number of layers, whether complete pallet layers must be shipped, and whether odd packs can be shipped.

The system can generate 'dummy' packs (empty boxes) to fulfil the 'complete layers' flag. There may even be complete 'dummy' layers up to the minimum number of layers.

Pack, Pallet and item weights and volumes are accumulated to calculate consignment totals, which can be maintained prior to confirmation of despatch.

ASN and ANSI X12 856 Maintenance and Send

ASNs are electronically transmitted messages (usually via EDI) which provide advance information about the configuration of Shipments or consignments. Normally an ASN will contain hierarchical information relating to the shipment itself; the orders or schedules on the shipment; the items contained in the shipment; and how those items are packaged.

Typically the ASN is transmitted to the delivery customer but in certain circumstances may be transmitted to other parties with an interest in the shipment, such as the carrier.

Original Equipment Manufacturers (OEMs) are increasingly placing a requirement upon their suppliers to transmit ASNs to them, often within a specified time span of the shipment actually leaving the suppliers plant. This time span is as small as fifteen minutes for some OEMs.

Many manufacturers wish to use the information contained in the ASN to streamline their Goods Receiving processes. The ASN information may include details of bar-coded packaging labels. Upon receipt, the bar-coded labels are read via hand held scanners and the goods contained within are automatically checked in to stock against expected receipts information provided by the ASN.

The screens relating to item details and their associated packaging details are optional. You can choose how deep into the maintenance options you wish to go by either accepting the packaging information already generated (or not if pack details are not required), or delving deeper and maintaining the packaging details manually.

The ANSI X12 856 ASNs is of increasing importance if you trade in, or with clients in, North America. It behaves in a similar way to a European ASN but differs in its use of the hierarchical levels and does not have a fixed structure. It therefore allows more specific data to be included. Hierarchical levels can be set up for each shipment in any sequence and levels can be omitted. The sequence is agreed between the customer and the supplier.

Record Locking Considerations

- Company and calendar maintenance require exclusive use of the system.
- The following simultaneous updates are prohibited via record locking:
 - Maintaining Contract Shipping details whilst processing it in Consignment Build.
 - Maintaining a Customer whilst processing one of their contracts in Shipping Processing.
 - Maintaining Despatch Profile / Pack /Pallet / Item whilst processing with them in Shipping Processing.



Note: The Style Advanced Shipping Notices Company, Customer, and Contract maintenance options will automatically be linked to the corresponding Advanced Customer Scheduling options if this is available, to prevent users having to enter details from two separate menu options when initially creating new Customer and Contract processing defaults.